

Trubel

QR-code album that scans guests' camera rolls automatically after the event. Two revenue streams: sub + 4K consumable.

What it is

Trubel is an iOS + Android photo-album app with QR-code magic. You host a hangout (birthday, bachelorette, housewarming, flatshare party), generate a QR card, every guest scans it and just takes photos normally with their phone camera. After the event the app scans your guests' camera roll automatically within the correct time window (optional GPS radius) and collects every photo into a single shared album. Optional: any host or guest can buy a 4K download of the full album as a one-time consumable.

Who it is for

Gen-Z friend-group leaders, party hosts, bachelorette and birthday planners, festival groups, study-abroad cohorts. Audience skews 18-28, heavily TikTok-leaning, iPhone-dominant (~80%). Creator archetypes that convert well: birthday-recap creators, bachelorette planners, college lifestyle accounts, flatshare content, festival vloggers, camera-roll-aesthetic accounts.

Key features

- QR-card hosting: per-event QR card design, guests scan once on arrival, no app account needed.
- Automatic camera-roll scan: pulls every photo from guests' rolls within the time window (+ optional GPS radius).
- Shared album per event: every member sees photos as they land, comment + react inline.
- World-Map public pin (Premium): discovery pin so friends-of-friends can find it.
- 4K full-album download (one-time, 1.99 USD): full event in print resolution.
- Multi-event hosting: birthdays, trips, parties - switch albums without re-onboarding guests.

Business model

- Two revenue streams: recurring Premium sub + one-time 4K-album consumable.
- Free tier generous: 3 active albums, 20 photos per album, 4 members per album.
- Premium unlocks: unlimited albums, photos, members + World-Map pin.
- Standalone consumable: 4K album 1.99 USD per album (no sub required).
- Free Lifetime Premium for onboarded affiliates.

Pricing

- Premium: ~5 EUR / month or ~30 EUR / year.
- 4K Album: 1.99 USD per album, one-time consumable.
- ASC live since May 2026; affiliate share is always 50% of the then-current price on both streams.

Market gap - what was missing

Group-event photo collection has been broken for 10+ years. The dominant pattern ("send me your pics" group chat) loses 70% of the photos by the third day. Web-based competitors (POV.contact, FridaySnap, Lapse, JOY) require guests to install something or upload manually - friction that kills participation. Apple Shared Albums work only for iPhone users and require accounts. Trubel's automatic camera-roll scan with a privacy-windowed time + GPS filter is genuinely category-of-one. The 4K-download consumable is the second unlock - it lets the album become a tangible, archival object.

Why now

Two structural shifts. First, iOS PhotoKit and Android MediaStore APIs reached a maturity in 2024-2025 where time + location-windowed reads are reliable and battery-cheap. Second, Gen-Z's relationship with the camera roll has shifted from "private archive" to "shareable artefact" (TikTok carousel + BeReal aesthetic). Audience is primed for an app that treats group events as memory artefacts rather than group-chat noise. The 4K-consumable rail lets a big-event creator monetise twice on the same content.

Affiliate compensation

- 50% of net Premium subscription revenue for 24 months from each attributed user's first paid month.
- 30-day refund holdback before payout becomes claimable (Apple / Google refund window).
- 50 EUR minimum payout, monthly, via Wise.
- Free Lifetime Premium for onboarded affiliates (no posting obligation).
- Per-handle dashboard with live click / install / sub / earning split, no agency layer.

How tracking works - DIY attribution stack

Most affiliate stacks ride on top of Branch.io, AppsFlyer or a similar paid attribution SDK. We built our own. Those tools charge per attributed install, they add a third party to the user's first-launch experience, and they make influencer payouts opaque. We wanted full control of every step from click to Wise transfer. The full path has six stages - link click, install, first launch attribution, Premium purchase, holdback, payout. Here is what runs in each stage.

Why we built our own instead of Branch.io

Three reasons. (1) Cost: Branch.io and AppsFlyer charge 0.20-0.40 USD per attributed install at our volume tier, which would have absorbed roughly 8-12% of the affiliate payout pool. With DIY we keep that for affiliates. (2) Privacy: each additional SDK reads first-launch context - that is another vendor with first-touch user data we did not want to add. Apple's App Tracking Transparency framework has also made probabilistic fingerprinting unreliable since iOS 14.5; the paid SDKs work around this with opaque heuristics that we could not audit. (3) Transparency: when a dashboard number looks wrong, we read our own code in 10 minutes instead of debugging a third-party black box. The trade-off is that we own the bugs. Every line of attribution code is in our repo.

Android: Google Play install-referrer

Android gives us the cleanest path. When a user taps your link, the Google Play Store install carries the original referrer string (a URL-encoded query parameter from the redirect chain) through to first launch via the Play Install Referrer API. On first launch the app reads `getInstallReferrer().getInstallReferrer()`, we parse the handle and source out of it, and write an attribution row in our Supabase table alongside the install event. Deterministic. No fingerprinting. No clipboard.

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iOS warm (app already installed)

If the user already has Trubel installed, iOS routes the tap through a Universal Link directly into the app with

Why this works as an affiliate pitch

Birthday and bachelorette content has explosive Gen-Z reach. The pain ("send me your pics" group chats that die in 4 days) is universal and concrete. Trubel's automatic camera-roll scan is genuinely category-of-one. Two revenue rails (sub + consumable) both pay the affiliate, so high-emotion-moment audiences (festivals, weddings) monetise twice.

On posts with affiliate link: #ad / #sponsored / Paid Partnership (FTC, EU disclosure law).